

MELODIC JUSTICE

By Karsten Allen

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MELODIC JUSTICE

We sit in the darkness. Soft piano chords play from a record player. Cold, steady progressions. As we fade in, we see Young Jax sitting at a piano with his brother Jett. He's playing a melody along with the chords on a record playing nearby. But he keeps slipping out of rhythm, falling out of sync.

Jax

Dang it!

Jett

Hey! Slow down, brother. The music's not going anywhere. A wise man once said, the notes are already there, you just gotta hit 'em right.

Young Jax tries again, this time listening more carefully to the chord progression. The melody starts to sync up.

Jett

There you go... let it come naturally.

Jax relaxes, finding the natural flow between his melody and the chords. His playing becomes more confident. He's about to finish the melody when-

CRASH! *The front door splinters inward. Dark, shadowy figures pour into the room. Their mother's scream pierces the air.*

Quick, dark fade in and out...

Jett

Hey, hey! This isn't-

SMACK! Dark tendrils and shadowy particles fill the air and begin to strangle the boys. Young Jax is **SLAMMED** to the ground by forces we can barely see. Through tear-filled eyes, he watches dark energy swirl around his brother.

Young Jax

What did you do, Jett?

Jett

(voice breaking, as the darkness closes in)

I'm sorry, Jax. Just close your eyes. Think about the music.

Jax closes his eyes. A loud stomp rings out. The chord progression from the record player comes to a close as we fade to black.

The words "2076..." fade in and out.

"12 years later"

After a few seconds, we hear the sound of a button click repeatedly... again... and again. A green flicker brightens the screen. It speeds up and we see our main character, Jax, under the covers of his bed accompanied by flashes of green light. He starts clicking the button on his Speed Relay; A common handheld power bank that can convert mental stress into reusable energy by just simply clicking a button. The clicking stops. Then, just dark silence...

EXT. STREETS OF METANEAPOLIS - DAY

We start to hear an acoustic guitar strum, a warm tune, the sound sits firmly in our ears. After several seconds of music, the sounds of busy streets surround

the music as the color fades in. As the guitar continues to play a warm melody, we transport around the city street.

The camera stops on Jax, sitting alone on a stool in front of Hiro's Music Store, strumming the guitar we were listening to. He is fully tuned in, humming along. After playing for a moment, he gets interrupted by a girl passing by.

Girl

That melody... who is that?

Jax

(looking up, surprised)

It's Yori... Takahashi. You know him?

Girl

Are you kidding? He's a long lost legend!

I've seen you out here before, you're always solo.

Jax

(adjusting guitar strap)

Just watching the shop while Hiro's away. Needed some air.

Girl

Well you sound pretty good, when did you learn to play?

Jax

(shrugs)

Been playing since I could read notes. Just do it as a hobby though.

Girl

Well hey, our guitarist just split. I could really use someone with your skills in my band

Jax

(guarded)

...ehhh I don't know, I usually work better alone.

Girl

Come on, man. No one plays real instruments anymore, it's all techy crap.

Jax

Well what happened with your last guy?

Girl

Alex... he was good. Really good. But he got mixed up in some bad things... took the usual wrong turns. Now it's just me and Kai.

Jax

(understanding, but hesitant)

I've just never done the band thing before. Not really my vibe.

Girl

Mine neither, at first. But you've got something special.

Jax

Well...

Girl

Just try one practice. Could be the start of something big. Or not. No pressure.

Jax

(small laugh, standing)

Alright. Maybe one practice.

Kiko

I'm Kiko.

Jax

Jax...

They exchange information on their Loops and Jax pulls out his Stress relay. He clicks it a few times as Kiko and him walk into the store he was sitting in front of. The camera pans out revealing the sign for Hiro's Music Store.

The sun goes down in time lapse as we cut to -

INT. JAX BEDROOM - LATE NIGHT

Jax sits on the side of his bed holding his guitar. He is practicing some more difficult songs, but struggling. He gets frustrated and sets the guitar down. He touches his communication device (Loop). It dings.

Jax

Call Hiro

The Loop dings again, then shuts off. Jax clicks it again

Jax

Call Hiro

The Loop dings once more, then shuts off.

Jax

On my own tonight...

Jax uses his loop to turn on a larger screen. He lays over onto the bed. On the screen, a news reporter speaks.

News Reporter

...and tensions continue to rise in the city of Metaneapolis tonight as more attacks plague the entertainment district. Sources report this might be connected to the recent uprising of a popular underground political group. With the violence getting worse, our citizens are left wondering. Will anybody in our government speak up??

The sound of a relay clicking gets quicker and quicker as we fade to black, but before we even realize, we're back awake. Jax snaps up quickly to the sound of an alarm on his Loop.

Jax

Oh shit!

Jax hobbles up and grabs his things as he swings out his door. As the door slams, some high-energy punk rock music plays and we see him running down the street. Jax continues to run, but the camera stops on the Melodic Justice Title..

MELODIC JUSTICE

a film by Karsten Allen

EXT. KAI'S GARAGE DOOR - LATE AFTERNOON

We fall back down to a door. Kiko is standing by it as Jax runs up in a hurry.

Kiko

Don't kill yourself, we haven't even got started!

Jax

I didn't want to be late on my first day.

Kiko

I'm just glad you could make it!

EXT. KAI'S GARAGE - LATE AFTERNOON

The camera follows them through the door, revealing Kai sprawled out on a beat-up couch, eyes glued to a Stress Relay broadcast. He jumps up at the sight of Jax, and Kiko introduces him.

Kiko

Kai, this is our new guitarist, Jax!

Kai studies the pink cybernetic implants framing Jax's face with genuine fascination. He grabs Jax's arm and pulls him into a dap.

Kai

Welcome to the cave, man. Those mods are sick!

Jax

Thanks! Nice haptic gloves.

Kai

Just wait 'til they're warmed up..

(showing off the garage)

This is technically my parents place, but don't worry about being too loud. They're locked into the VR world.

Kiko

We're all clear to rock out.

Jax

Haha, hopefully I can keep up. I played a couple of songs last night-

Jax leans up against the coffee table, and it makes a mechanical whir. Kai Jax and Jax look at it inquisitively. Kai gives it another hard shove. The table pulls out and flips over from a coffee table to a pool table. Cues and all.

Kiko

(to Kai)

You didn't know it could do that?

Kai

What? No! This is awesome!

Jax

Now we can play some pool later.

Kai

Man... they just don't make stuff like this anymore.

Kiko

If only we could transform you into a better drummer.

Kai

Best one you know

Kiko

Alright, alright. You two ready to get playing?

Kai

Yup!

Kai reaches for the pool cues.

Kiko

I mean our instruments, dummy.

Kai

Oh... yeah!

Kiko walks them back to the practice area.

Kiko

Kai is usually set up in the corner, you can set up on the other side.

Jax seats himself at a stool and surveys the room as Kiko walks him through the setup. He takes out his amp and sets it up, anxiously awaiting criticism from the band mates for his hardware.

Kai

I love that guitar. Very old school.

Kiko

It really is unique, my keytar could never emulate that.

Jax

(genuinely)

Thanks!

Kiko

Alright, let's get started...

We go through a short montage. Kai slips his gloves on, Kiko sets the sound on her keyboard, but Jax just twists his tuning pegs.

Kai

Are you ready to rock and roll old school cool?

Jax

I think s-

Kai

Let's go!! 1, 2, 1 2 3 and

They begin to play. We see Jax frantically trying to keep up with them. He keeps up but just barely.

Kai notices him struggling.

Kai

(not missing a beat)

Relax, my guy! You're overthinkin' it. It's about feeling. Ride the wave!

Jax closes his eyes. He focuses. Just as he starts to get the hang of it, the song ends.

Jax sits with his eyes still closed, anticipating disappointment.

After finishing, Kiko shares her excitement.

Kiko

Now that's what I'm talking about!

Kai

Dude, nice! You're like, exactly what we needed!

Jax

Wow, thanks! That felt good after I got into it.

Kai

Timing is everything, man. You just gotta get in that zone. Let's hit it again.

They begin to play again. Kai leading them in. The music goes wild and the artists jam out. Through Kiko's goggles, we see the bandmates' relays glow. Colorful explosions appear behind Kai and Kiko, but the colors behind Jax are muted. The music continues to crescendo for a few moments when it suddenly stops and the screen goes black.

...

We fade back in to see everyone has collapsed from exhaustion. Kiko is laid against the wall, Kai has his head on the drums, arms laid out and drumsticks still in hand. Jax is in the middle of the floor with his strap still around him, the guitar lying to his side. Kiko starts to sit up...

Kiko

(exhausted)

So Jax, those mods on your head ... What's their story?
If you don't mind me asking.

Jax

(sits up)

Oh, yeah, it's interesting. TrickTech neural implants. They keep my brain from failing.

Kai

Pretty advanced tech just to keep the lights on.

Jax

It wasn't exactly my choice. I have to use my Stress Relay to provide power to them...

Kai

Wow. I just use mine to charge my Loop.

Jax

Oh, that too.

(they laugh)

My brother Jett... he got mixed up with the wrong people... **Black Sun**.

Kiko

(straightening up)

Black sun? I've never heard of 'em

Kiko

I've seen that on the news... some kind of gang?

Jax

More than that. They found out Jett was selling information to their enemies. They came for all of us...

(staring down at the floor)

They took everything. My brother, my family... even took part of me.

Kiko

Jax... I'm so sorry.

Kai

(clicking his relay slowly)

That's heavy, man...

Kiko

But someone has to be fighting back against them right?

Jax

They're an evil group of people. Their leader, **THE SHADOW**. He finds people when they're struggling. Takes that struggle and feeds it back to them as fuel. He turns their pain into power.

Kai

There's a lot of people hurting out here.

Kiko

So they target anyone who's vulnerable or angry?

Jax

It works better than you'd think. And once they turn you, there's no coming back. You become one of them. An umbral. It's impossible to track them down. They're everywhere but nowhere.

*Dark tendrils take over the screen to transition into black then to a **Black Sun** introduction montage. Jax's voice carries over dark, atmospheric shots of the city's underbelly:*

Jax (V.O.)

They barely have to hide, the dark energy does the work for them. All black, moving like shadows. There's something off about them. Their mark is all over the city. He calls them his 'umbrals.'

Quick cuts of masked figures, their symbol appearing in graffiti.

Jax (V.O.)

THE SHADOW? He's like their leader.

*We see an underground concert venue, neon lights still pulsing. **THE SHADOW** stands among destroyed instruments, his hand crushing a microphone. The neon signs flicker and die.*

Jax (V.O.)

I've never seen his real face. Every trace of him just vanishes.

THE SHADOW

(addressing umbrals)

**THE MUSICIANS, THE ARTISTS...THEY THINK THEY'RE BETTER
THAN YOU. I'M HERE TO BRING YOUR POWER BACK!**

Jax (V.O. cont'd)

When they figured out how to turn stress into power,
he built machines that don't just take your energy,
they take everything you are. They turn people into
shells. Into slaves.

*The destroyed venue transforms into a **Black Sun**
facility, music equipment twisted into torture
devices.*

Montage fades to black and then we fade back in.

Kiko

(processing)

So how do they even do this? How do you "turn"
someone?

Jax

The stress relay. The tech was meant to help people
use their stress for good. THE SHADOW corrupted it. My
brother found out. He was using it to manipulate
people's pain.

Kiko

Wait, Stress Relay tech? Like... Dr. White's invention??

Jax

(holds his relay up)

These right here

Kai

(pulls his loop out)

No way. Dr. White is my HERO, man. I've watched every interview. Here, this one's from the original announcement.

Kai shows them the Dr. White video.

Kiko

So **THE SHADOW** stole Dr. White's invention and weaponized it.

Jax

Years ago he attacked the facility and stole prototypes. Dr. White barely survived. He's been silently rebuilding his empire ever since.

Kai

Alex...before he left the band. He was acting weird. He kept saying he met some people who "actually got him".

Kiko

No way you're thinking he's with them now.

Kai

We sent him that message kicking him out. He didn't even respond. Just left our lives. I knew he was angry.

Jax

That's when they get you. When you're isolated. Angry and alone.

Kai

Shit

Kiko

Can you come back? If you've been turned?

Jax

(shaking head)

I don't think so.

(a brief silence)

Kiko

Well someone needs to stop them.

Jax

I wish them good luck, no one has yet...

Well thank you guys for hearing me out... I had fun playing! I do have to get going though. Same time tomorrow?

Kiko

You're actually coming back?

Jax

As long as you want me.

Kai

(grinning)

Dude, I need the backup. This one's been running the show solo for too long.

Kiko

(smirking)

Someone has to keep you in line.

Jax

(laughing)

Alright guys, I'm heading out.

Jax begins folding up his amp and heading to the door.

Kai

(walking Jax to the door, he puts his arm around him)

Alright man, I'm excited to play with you again. Just try not to get TOO good. I like being the star.

Kiko

Have a good night, Jax

Jax

You too, see ya.

We cut to black when the door shuts. After a moment of silence, we cut to Jax in his bed.

INT. JAX'S BEDROOM - NIGHT

Anxious music starts to ramp up and we hear the stress relay button clicking again.

*We quickly cut back in and out of a closeup of Jax in bed. He's asleep and having a bad dream. He jerks left and right. We see a quick glimpse of Alex suffering. He sees moments from his brother's death and **Black Sun's** attack flash on the screen.*

Jett

I'm sorry, Jax.

-

the music...

Jax snaps awake. He sends his arms out in a panic, feeling along the desk beside him. He calms down and grabs the Loop. He scrolls through comments on the latest Melodic Justice Holo. He begins to notice all the hate comments have black profile pictures. Jax closes the Loop with a frustrated sigh.

Jax

I need to get out of here.

Jax tosses his Loop onto the desk. Cut to

EXT. ABANDONED ROOFTOP - LATE NIGHT

Jax makes his way onto a rooftop with an abandoned section overgrown with foliage and plants. A forgotten greenhouse sits in the middle. He makes his way over and opens the creaky door. Broken glass panes let in the night air, many of the plants continue to grow wild, reclaiming the space. He settles on an old crate with his guitar in his lap.

He strums a section of a song that mirrors his melody from the beginning, but this time slower, more contemplative. City lights pulse through the broken glass panes. Jax sits and watches the plants. For a moment it's like the plants are moving with his music. He smiles faintly.

Jax

(to the plants)

You guys get it, right?

We fade into the next day through a rooftop timelapse.

EXT. HIRO'S MUSIC STORE - MID-DAY

We see Jax jogging into the shop with his guitar around his back. The door closes behind him and we follow him inside handheld-style. He's in a hurry.

INT. HIRO'S MUSIC STORE - MID-DAY

Jax comes running into the shop, swinging the guitar into his hands. Hiro stands behind the main counter.

Jax

Hiro! You're finally back! Check this out. I got asked to join a band.

He throws his loop onto the counter and plays a holo. Hiro watches intently.

Hiro

Your high E string is sounding much better... Have you been working on it?

Jax

Always.

They move over to Hiro's workbench, and Jax lays his guitar on it. Hiro begins working on the guitar while still watching the holo.

Hiro

Your technique is better. More confident. Less...
overthinking.

Jax

With Kiko and Kai, it felt different. I didn't have to
carry all the weight alone.

Hiro

That's wonderful to hear. Kiko's got quite the ear.
Always asking about my vintage synths.

(gesturing to the synth area)

Jax

You know everybody, don't you?

Hiro

Too many people. But you three... there's something
special here. The old school sound, but with heart.
That's what this district's been missing.

Jax

I know! We have a small concert coming up soon if you
want to come. I'll get you in.

Hiro

I would love to come, but the store has been busy in
my absence. I hate to get away for too long, but I
will do my best to be there...

I always knew music would take you far.

Jax

And how did you know that?

Hiro

Because I taught you everything you know.

(they smile)

Jax

Hahaha. With your support though, I think we could do really well. It's been a long time since an old school band made waves in this district. I'm thankful for all you've done for me and I want to pay it back...

by becoming the greatest artist alive.

(Jax and Hiro chuckle)

Hiro

I only took you in, the purpose you've been given was forged by you... I merely gave it the room to grow. I think it's time. I've been saving something special. For when you were ready.

(turning back)

And you're ready.

Hiro removes Jax' guitar from the counter. He reaches down and bends over to look under the counter. He pulls out a shiny new guitar case. He sets the case up on the counter and slowly opens it up. Inside is a pristine electric guitar with elegant black and blue patterns. Jax has never seen one so nice and in such good condition. It was clearly made many years ago by a skilled craftsman.

Jax

Wow Hiro, *this...* is for me?

Hiro

I've been holding on to it for years, but I always knew it should fall into your hands. It will help you find your style.

Jax

(still wide-eyed)

Well thank you, Hiro... this means a lot to me. I'll take super good care of it, I promise.

Hiro

(nods)

This is a very special instrument, Jax. You will learn this guitar, but the guitar will have to learn you too. Treat it well

Jax

What do you mean by that?

Random Customer

(yelling to Hiro from across store)

-Are these the ones on sale or...?

Hiro

(yelling back to customer)

One moment - I'll be right with you!

(looks back to Jax)

I have to help this customer, but go now, try it out with your band. Let me know how it goes!

Jax then heads out of the store as Hiro runs to help the customer.

INT. KAI'S GARAGE - NIGHT

We cut back to the garage. All of our band members are sitting around and chatting before they practice.

Kiko

We should be recording these sessions and putting them out into the world. Maybe we can grow a local fan base before our first gig. Just some people from this district.

Kai

Dude that's a good idea, why haven't I thought of that already?

Kiko

I don't think you do much thinking at all.

(Kai chuckles and then Jax)

Besides, my goggles record everything. But we can still set up another hologram or two.

Jax

You really think we can be a big famous band?

Kai

Dude. We live in Metaneapolis!

(he throws his arms out)

Anything is possible in the entertainment district.

Kiko

It doesn't hurt to put our hologram out there.

Jax

Speaking of trying new things. Check this out, Hiro gave me this new guitar. I've only looked, but I haven't tried it out yet.

He lifts the lid of the case and slides the guitar out for the first time. Amidst pulling out the guitar, a tiny box is revealed to be hidden behind the neck.

Jax

Wait, I didn't see this...?

Jax opens the box and reveals an upgraded, more fancy Stress Relay than his current one. He looks back to the guitar and notices an outlet in the bottom that the stress relay can plug into.

Kai

Woahhhh that thing is beautiful, man. The pickup reminds me of the old school DigiTones.

(to Jax)

Remember that insane feedback Akeshta used to get? That's how he did it... And another relay too?!

Kiko

Hiro just gifted these to you? What a sweetheart!

Jax

That guy. He's always been good to me... he said this guitar will help me on my journey. I thought I'd test it out with you guys tonight.

Kai

Pop quiz! Hook it up to that amp and we can just start from anywhere.

Jax

(fumbling with the cords)

Hmm. One moment here-

Kai

-Alllllrrrright let's go!

1... 2... 1, 2, 3 and

Jax quickly plugs the cord into the guitar and starts to play. It sounds noticeably smoother and the tone is clear, but Jax still needs some work. We see through Kiko's goggles once again. Colorful explosions come from behind the band as they play, Jax's are ranging in color and value from low to bright with his gained confidence. They pause the song to talk.

Kiko

Woah! That sounded different!

Kai

Dude you were locked-in that time? Was it playing *FOR* you??

Jax

Nah, man. This thing just feels different, like it's responding to me.

Kiko

(sarcastically)

Okay buddy. Let's try another song. Test Track 4

We zoom into a montage...

Quick cuts of the band's rise:

-Views climbing on their holograms

-Fans putting on Melodic Justice merch

-Their symbol appearing as street art

*The music starts to wane. The tone shifts as we fade to darkness. A single screen illuminates a dark office. **THE SHADOW** towers over the ex bandmate Alex, now an Umbral. Closeup on **THE SHADOW's** mask as he watches Melodic Justice perform. His hand **CRUSHES** the device as recognition hits. A memory flashes of a younger Jett clutching stolen plans. Back in the present, **THE SHADOW** pulls out a dark, jerry-rigged Stress Relay prototype and pulls out the attached cord. He connects it to a **Black Sun** necklace.*

THE SHADOW

SO...HIS BROTHER LIVES.

THE SHADOW dangles the **Black Sun** necklace before Alex's terrified face.

THE SHADOW

(voice warping)

ANOTHER MUSICIAN.

(to Alex)

WHAT DO YOU KNOW?

Alex

(trembling)

NO—NOTHING. I WAS JUST WATCHING—

THE SHADOW opens a compartment and flips a switch. The connected relay components begin to glow. Dark energy pulses within it. Alex recoils as **THE SHADOW** unleashes an inhuman roar.

Sharp contrast, we cut to Dr. White's pristine white office. He watches Melodic Justice on his Loop, completely absorbed. The hologram suddenly corrupts and black tendrils crawl across the screen before dying. White stares at his reflection on the black screen with a tilted head.

Fade back to the garage...

INT. KAI'S GARAGE - NIGHT

Kiko

One of our Holos got taken down. I should probably stop posting them under my real name. I think it's time to come up with an official band name.

Kai

Finally! I've been sitting on some gold for weeks. Alright, hear me out. Drum roll please.

No one drum rolls.

The Treble Makers.

Jax

That's what you've been sitting on for weeks?.

Kiko

Hate it.

Kai

Okay, damn! What about...The Clef Hangers

Jax

It's not terrible

Kiko

Really?

Kai

Tempo-Tantrum

Jax

Okay you gettin' somewhere now.

Kiko

Guys-

Kai

Bass Invaders

Jax

Haha!-

Kiko

-Guys! We need something that doesn't sound like a retro arcade game.

Jax

(after a beat)

Kiko is right. Maybe we need a name that actually means something. Like...what are we doing here?

Kai

Making sick drum beats.

Jax

No, I'm serious... after everything we've talked about and put into the songs. Black Sun, what happened to Alex.

Kiko

We aren't just making music. We're standing up to something.

Jax

Exactly

Kai

Like Dr. White was talking about. Darkness to light.

Jax

My brother Jett always said that music is more than the songs or albums. It's about the artist behind it.

Kai

So we're what? Musical vigilantes?

Kiko

(shaking head, grabbing nose)

Please don't put that on a poster

Kai

Think about it. We're bringing justice, through melody.

Jax

Melodic Justice.

Kai

Melodic Justice.

Kiko

... I'm not saying that

They all stare at each other blankly for a moment. Then we quickly cut to see Kai spray-paint Melodic Justice on his drums. The camera zooms in and fades into the black between the words. We see a short montage of the Holos getting more exposure than ever, the numbers are exploding! However, the darkness still takes over, and we fade to black. When we cut back in, the band is back in the garage.

INT. KAI'S GARAGE - MID DAY

Kiko is holding her Loop up with a message. A hologram peaks out with Stress Relay genius Doctor White. Kai and Jax crowd around Kiko's Loop.

Dr. White (over Loop)

Melodic Justice. Your sound, your message. It's exactly what this district needs. I've seen your Holos disappearing lately, and as CEO of Stress Relay, I want to help. So; I have an offer. I would love to sponsor you for your first big concert event! You focus on the music, I'll handle the rest. Shoot me a message to figure out the details.

(hologram closes out)

Kai

I'm gonna pass out-

Kiko

-Guys...this is incredible news!! THE Maxwell White wants to sponsor us?

Jax

Wow! I'm speechless. I never thought we would catch the attention of someone like him. How did he even find us-

Kai

(jumping up)

Probably my last drum solo! That Holo was sickkkkkk! Do you think he saw my solo?!

Jax

I'm not sure, but I'm excited to see the turnout! A concert would be insane!

Kiko

Alright, focus up, y'all! We've got work to do. If we're playing for Dr. White...

Jax

(grinning)

We better make it good.

Kai

Let's run it again.

They launch into their song again as we fade out...

We see a sky transition through a few days...

Fade into...

INT. CONCERT VENUE - MID-DAY

Inside the venue, the band stands together hanging posters. Dr. White walks inside with a giant cane with a glowing red ball. On top, a relay button. Jax and Kai freeze while Kiko beams an eager smile at him.

Dr. White

(walking up)

The wonderfully talented Melodic Justice. That last Holo was something else. Especially that drum solo.

(he points to Kai)

Kai

(stammering)

I - I, um -

Kiko

(interrupting)

Thank you, sir! We're ready to deliver.

Dr. White

I know the concert isn't for another week, but I wanted to get together and meet before the big day.

Kai

We can't wait to be huge!

Dr. White

About that. Your Holos, it seems they keep vanishing.

Kiko

Yeah, it's been hurting our popularity rank.

Dr. White

I have a feeling someone might be targeting them. But fear not, I know a couple of guys over at Loop's video studios. I'll see what I can do to get you guys an agent.

Dr White's Loop begins to ring. He looks at the band, opens his mouth as if to say something. The loop rings again. You can see the urgency in his eyes.

--I'm so sorry, I've got to take this.

The doctor walks away towards the bathrooms.

Jax

Did that just happen?

Kai

We just met a living legend.

(he sits down)

Kiko

(tossing pile of posters onto Kai)

Less fanboying, more hanging.

Jax

(chuckles)

I'm gonna head to the restroom while you work on that.

*Jax starts to walk to the nearby restroom, walking past Dr. White on the Loop. He struts up and begins to overhear the doctor's conversation. Jax hears mention of the **Black Sun** group.*

Dr. White

(from corner)

...I have done nothing to disturb **The Black Sun**. Sir,
you don't understand... Okay...

Jax is around the corner now listening closely. The doctor begins to walk towards him. Jax quickly rushes into the bathroom to avoid him. The doctor hangs up the Loop.

Dr. White

(to himself)

That damned Arashi is always ruining my plans.

We see him walk away, back towards Kai and Kiko. Jax runs into the restroom. He stands against the wall and thinks to himself

Jax

I know that ain't what it sounds like. What does Dr. White know about **The Black Sun**?

Jax walks back to the group, pulling up his zipper and giving a questioning stare to Dr. White. He gets within earshot of the three.

Dr. White

Well hey guys, I'm sorry to leave so quickly, but I've got a lot on my plate today. I will see you at the concert and be sure to stay in touch. I already can't wait for the show!

Kiko

We're gonna rock your socks off!

Kai

(extra professional)

Hell yeah sir, thank you for stopping by and blessing us with your sponsorship.

Jax joins the conversation. Peering at the doctor as he walks away, suspicious of him now...

Dr. White.

(turning around)

Oh and it was nice meeting you as well, Jax!

Jax

(trying to read him, but remaining cordial)

Of course! We'll see you soon, Doc!

Dr. White

Take care...

The doctor walks away. Kiko and Kai look back at their posters and talk. Jax looks at the ground, deep in thought. We hear the relay button clicking go from quiet to loud. As the loudest one clicks, Jax looks up and we cut to black while the sound echoes.

INT. JAX'S ROOM - AFTER MIDNIGHT

Several seconds later we cut back into Jax having trouble sleeping again. However, this time, he wakes right up. When he sits up in bed, he stares blankly for a second. He then grabs his Loop and calls Hiro. In the middle of the night, Hiro picks up almost immediately.

Jax

Hiro. Were you already awake?

Hiro

Um, yes. I've been having some late nights. What is keeping you up, Jax?

Jax

I've been having trouble sleeping too... too many things in my head. This concert is coming up soon, and there's a lot on my mind. Do you know anything about the CEO of Stress Relay?

Hiro

Ahh, yes, Doctor Maxwell White. A good man.

Jax

A good man? I'm glad to hear that.

Hiro

Why yes, he's done a lot for my business and many other small businesses in the district. He has kept us afloat when times get tough.

Jax

Wow. I didn't know that. He discovered our band. He's sponsoring a show for us. Handling everything.

Hiro

That is wonderful news, what a good person to have close! For a man who's half machine, he's got quite a heart.

Jax

Half machine?

Hiro

Actually, your stories aren't so different. His body was... rebuilt. After an attack.

Jax

Who attacked him?

Hiro

Take a guess...

Jax

It was him, wasn't it.

Hiro

THE SHADOW came for him after Stress Relay launched. They've been enemies ever since.

Jax

(quietly)

Wow, so **Black Sun**'s taken from both of us.

Hiro

Your stories are similar, but you are both inspiring
in your own ways. What is bothering you?

Jax

Well... I just overheard Dr. White take an unusual call.
He mentioned **The Black Sun**. And I wanted to get to
know the guy who's been helping us so much.

Hiro

I would not worry too much Jax. They have been a thorn
in the doctor's side for a long time. Like I always
say; Focus on the music and focus on yourself. The
rest will sort itself out.

Jax

Okay... you're probably right. Get some rest, sir.

Hiro

You too, Jax. Sleep well.

*The Loop dims. Jax lies back, city lights playing
across his face as his eyes close.*

Fade to morning...

INT. KAI'S GARAGE - DAY

*The band is playing a song that we have heard before,
but it's much clearer now. We see all of the musicians
in their element. Each jamming out respectively. As
the song plays, we focus on Kai's Stress Relay
charging his haptic glove. Energy flowing to it. We
see Kiko's Keytar screen lighting up. Kai's drum pad
plays in a loop alongside him. We see a close up of
his drum pad machine playing "Kai Loop 419". After the
song they lean back and talk.*

Jax

I think I'm 'bout ready for the show.

Kai

I was born ready.

(holds up music screen, notes scribbled all over)

I've been studying all week.

Jax

I didn't even know you *could* read.

Kai

(nonchalantly)

That one was low, man.

Kiko

(looking down at her Keytar.)

Hey guys, lets -

The garage doorbell rings. Jax, Kai, and Kiko all look at the door, surprised. They pause for a second in silence. Kiko goes towards the door with curiosity, the boys follow behind. She opens the door to see who's there. No one. We look down, a black package is sitting on the door mat.

Kai

Fan mail?

Kiko picks the box up, looks back and forth outside,

(gestures to the box)

Jax and Kai

(come closer to look)

Jax

What is that?

Kiko

It's definitely addressed to us.

*We see the box is stamped with "Melodic Justice". Kiko opens up the device, and a digital holo-letter opens up. A **Black Sun** Necklace is revealed to be sitting in the box.*

Kiko

(reading)

to Kiko Matamishi, Jax Foster, and the other Melodic Justice band member:

Kai

What the hell-

Kiko

(continuing)

"We are writing to you to demand that you immediately disband. Your presence in this district is unwanted. We have been watching you, and your music will not be tolerated."

*As Kiko reads the letter, the **Black Sun** necklace begins to float up in the air, as if it has a mind of its own.*

Kai and Jax follow it with their eyes as Kiko continues to read... They gaze, terrified at the dark energy flowing out of it...

Kiko

(cont'd)

"This is your first and final warning. Your safety and the safety of those around you are at stake. **THE BLACK SUN** suggests you heed our warning and disappear into the shadows."

Kai

(staring at the floating necklace)

Man what the f-

The necklace flies abruptly right to Kai's neck. It slams him to the wall and wraps tightly around his throat.

Kiko

Kai!!!

Kiko runs over to Kai as he falls to the ground. They struggle. Jax stands frozen. She tries to tear it off of him but it won't budge. Jax finally snaps to and runs over to help. They struggle... and pull...

A rising beep noise begins... and when it seems all hope is lost, the necklace releases a giant burst of dark energy. The burst zaps between each member of the band before dying out. The necklace powers down and falls to the ground. When it hits the ground, a burst of energy comes out and it slowly starts to float again. Kai gets to his feet quickly and kicks the necklace with all his might. It flies across the room before floating up and exiting through a window.

Kai

(coughing and wheezing)

Holy jeez man...

Kiko

Hey hey, It's okay, I think it's gone now.

Kai

What the hell was that for? I'm just here to play the drums, man!

Kiko

It's going to be okay, I think it was just a warning.

Kai

(clicking his relay)

Warning? It almost killed me!

Kiko

If it wanted to kill you, it would have.

Jax

Are you okay, man? That thing really had a hold on you.

Kai

I'm cool now... but I'm never wearing a necklace again
I'll tell you that.

Kiko

This isn't good.

Jax

(clicking his relay)

Not at all. Looks like they were trying to send a message. Kiko's right, it just gave up. It didn't want to kill you.

Kiko

They want us to stop making music because we actually stand for something.

Kai

That's easy for you to say.

Kiko

We can't just let them scare us into silence.

Jax

Our music is supposed to be powerful, and it's meant to be heard.

Kai

I know... We have to keep playing, no matter what.

Jax

We can't let fear control us. They just want control.

Kai

I'll die for this band. Even if it kills me.

Kiko

It's not illegal to make music. Don't forget, Kai. We have the CEO of Stress Relay and all of our followers on our side. We could talk to Dr. White about getting more security for the show. That way nothing like this has to happen to any of our fans.

Kai

With the help of Dr. White, **Black Sun** can't do SHIT to us!

Jax

(stops clicking)

I think you're right. **Black Sun** doesn't care about what's right or wrong, they just want to be in control. We can't stand down. This gig is coming up and we're going to show just how much power we have. We have a whole district of fighters behind us too. I'd like to see them take down all of us.

Cut to black.

EXT. HIRO'S MUSIC SHOP - MIDNIGHT

Jax walks up to the store and goes inside.

INT. HIRO'S MUSIC SHOP - MIDNIGHT

*Jax walks in, ready to tell Hiro about the threat from **Black Sun**. He walks in while he's in the middle of something secret. Hiro quickly hides what he was working on behind the counter. Jax doesn't notice. He starts to talk to Hiro...*

Hiro

I don't understand. How did **Black Sun** learn about your band?

Jax

That's one thing I can't seem to make sense of, we put a lot of Holos up, but how did we upset a whole organization?

Hiro

This could be concerning Jax, they may be keeping an eye on you, they are trying to silence you. The **Black Sun** does not forget people. And your family was once connected to --

Jax

--Hiro, stop. I know what happened to my family. To me. But I believe in our message. I believe in the music we make. We want to spread good intentions and make real change. You said we can trust Dr. White too.

The only problem is that I know **Black Sun** will do whatever it takes to stop us from creating our music. But I can't let them keep hurting anyone. What should I do?

Hiro

I understand... I'm just saying to be careful. I think you need to stay vigilant. I do trust Dr. White, but everyone has their secrets. You need to talk to Dr. White. Try to talk to him. If you trust him still; you can let him know your worries.

Jax

Kiko and Kai wanted to meet him at his office tonight whenever he's available.

Hiro

I think that's a good idea. It will ease your mind. You need peace before the concert.

Jax

I know. This is so stressful Hiro. Sometimes I just want to put it all down... and give up the music. It feels like only bad things have come of it...

Hiro

Stop with the music? What has happened to you? Nothing good has come of it??

Jax

(throwing up his arms furiously)

Well it all just goes to shit!

Hiro

(slowing down)

Here, Jax, take a seat... Listen to me... You have done so much growing since I took you in. You have found a way to use music to fight the issues from your past. You are doing amazing now! You were a sheltered kid when we first crossed paths. Now look at the bond you've built with these people. Nothing good has come of this?? You're the happiest you've been since I met you!

Jax

Well, I know. It hasn't all been bad... But I can't keep letting the people around me get involved. It's hard to stay motivated when everything I do gets someone hurt. Maybe I *should* give up. Maybe I *wasn't* meant to be a musician.

Hiro

You know, Jax. Let me tell you something. When you play that guitar... I hear echoes of someone else. *Something* else.

Jax

What does that mean?

Hiro

The man who owned this guitar before you; he faced incredible odds.

Jax

Previous owner? I didn't know there was one?

Hiro

I made this for an artist when they needed some extra support. He was known around the world. An icon, even.

Jax's face lights up with excitement. He looks down at the guitar again.

Hiro

But it wasn't all good times for him either. When an illness took over, and his body began to fail him, doctors said he'd never play again. For his whole life, he kept his illness a secret to the world. He almost quit on the day he was diagnosed...

Jax

What happened to him?

Hiro

Instead of giving up, he changed his approach. When his fingers couldn't move fast enough, he stayed up day and night making his own prosthetics. Working with every doctor and every musician he could find. His music became even more powerful. He became an icon. Not because he overcame the limitations, but because he embraced them. He kept fighting on. He put his pain into the music. He knew that his story made him who he *is*.

Jax

Woah... So that's why you gave me his guitar?

Hiro

I see the same fire in you, Jax. The same stubborn refusal to let the world decide what you can and can't do.

Jax

Who was he, Hiro?

Hiro

(slowing down)

That... will have to wait for another time. You need to address these issues with Dr. White as soon as possible.

Jax

(nodding)

You're right. Thank you, Hiro. For Everything.

Hiro

That guitar will protect you as much as I did, Jax. Just remember that.

We hear the music shop door bell ring as Jax swings out the front door. He thinks to himself

Jax

I can't believe I'm holding an instrument with that kind of history. Maybe Hiro is right. This guitar has seen battles before. And so have I. My struggles have always been my best motivator... We really need to meet with Dr. White before the concert

Jax looks down to his loop.

Jax

Call Kiko and Kai

Kiko picks up on ring two.

Kiko

Jax? What's up

Jax

What are you guys up to here in a bit? Want to head to Dr. White's?

Kiko

Yeah. Kai is still resting after the necklace attack. I'll pick him up. Meet there in a half hour?

Jax

Can do.

Kiko

Okay, see ya.

Jax

Bye.

The Loop closes down. Jax sighs. We stop for a second before the camera turns over to a Stress Relay billboard on the street. It fades to the next scene of the Stress Relay offices sign. We pan down and see Jax outside the offices, and Kiko and Kai are walking up.

Kai

Oh hey, funny seeing you here.

Jax

I'm sorry we had to interrupt your nap.

Kai

I just survived an attack! Besides, I'll do anything to see my hero!

Jax

I'm your hero?

Kai

What?

Jax

What?

Kiko

My goodness, you too. Let's get to it, the concert is tomorrow. You told him we're coming, right?

Jax

Yup. He said he'll be here all night.

Jax leads the band inside to a digital front desk assistant. The pristine lobby shines around them.

INT. OFFICE BUILDING - EARLY AFTERNOON

Jax

Hello, we're here to see Dr. White...?

Digital Assistant

Melodic Justice. Your elevator is ready.

The door dings open. The band mates stand inside, cramped. Their music plays on the speaker.

Kai

Wait, I think I've heard this song.

Jax

That's us, dipshit.

We cut to the elevator at the top floor, the door opens and the band mates are scrunched in tightly. Jax pops out, Kai and Kiko follow. They approach a window looking out over the city.

Kai

That's one big district.

Kiko

Wow...

Jax

Maybe someday, we can all live up this high.

Kai

Some of us already do, man.

Dr. White emerges from his office, his red cane pulses softly.

Dr. White

(warmly)

Melodic Justice! To what do I owe the pleasure?

Kiko

Um... we need to talk.

Dr. White

By all means.

He leads them into his office, Kiko and Jax take the chairs. Kai perches anxiously on a stool, drumming his fingers.

Dr. White

(settling behind his desk)

I'm all ears.

The band exchanges glances. Finally, Kiko starts—

Kiko

(stuttering)

Some-something happened—

Jax

(leaning forward)

Black Sun came for us.

(gestures to Kai's neck)

And they left a mark.

Dr. White

(smile fading)

Dammit... I apologize. I feared this would come. I was a fool to think I could keep you safe by keeping you all in the dark.

Kiko and Kai snap their heads toward him, concerned, scared, and shocked all in one. Dr White hesitates, his hand trembling in fear. Jax notices.

Jax

Doctor, are you okay?

Dr. White

I... yes.

(he calms)

You need to know the truth.

(he turns his screen around)

They've been busy. They were the ones taking down
your holograms.

(removes sunglasses, revealing cybernetic eyes)

We have... history.

Kai

Holy sh—

Dr. White

Years ago, when Stress Relay was just starting out...
They threatened me too.

(touching his metallic eye)

In my experience, they seem to have a specific issue
with musicians. And by they, I mean him.

Jax

You mean, **THE SHADOW?**

Dr. White

That's the one. Someone warned me he was coming.
Planning an attack on my facility. An anonymous
message came telling me to be ready.

Jax

My brother was trying to expose the Black Sun. From
the inside. He knew about their plans to attack Stress
Relay.

Dr. White

Your brother...worked with the Black Sun?

Jax

He tried to tear it down from the source.

Dr. White

Someone tried to save my life that day. I was so full of myself back then, I didn't listen. Brushed it off as some corporate fear tactic.

Jax

That was probably Jett. He died because they found out he was trying to help people.

Dr. White

I think your brother tried to save me. He knew how dangerous they were. I should have done something a long time ago.

Kiko

(processing)

Well now you can, Doctor. We might need to cancel the show!-

Dr. White

(sharply)

-No!

(he pauses, collecting himself)

We stand our ground. I'll double the security, triple it if I have to.

Kai

And what if they come again?

Jax

They've always stayed hidden. They wouldn't make a big scene in public.

Dr. White

(standing)

I will be there personally. And trust me...

(cane glowing brighter)

Their influence is nothing compared to mine. I will get the necessary things in place to ensure everyone's safety. Our venue is in the most secure part of the district...

They've taken enough from all of us, I won't let it happen again.

Kai

Thank you, Dr. White

They sit in a brief moment of silence.

Dr. White

Now, as great as this stress is for energy, I think you all deserve a nice long rest before the concert. I'll send you home with new Relays. Take it easy and recharge.

Dr. White hands them each a brand new relay. Kiko and Kai grab theirs and begin to walk to the door. Jax goes to grab his relay, but Dr. White pauses for just a second. He makes eye contact with Jax, and then sets the relay in his hand. As if to tell him something.

Kiko

Thanks again for your help.

Dr. White

Take care of each other out there. See you tomorrow.

The group heads towards the elevator to leave. Dr. White waves them off. The elevator closes and we cut to black.

After some seconds, we hear noises bouncing around in Jax's head. No images this time. Just constant noise. Then we jump awake.

" -CONCERT DAY- "

" -4 AM- "

It's the middle of the night and Jax is wide awake. He can't take the confinement of his room any more. He jumps up and grabs his new stress relay and guitar. He walks out of the door.

EXT. ABANDONED ROOFTOP GREENHOUSE - EARLY AM (DARK)

We transition to Jax walking on the rooftops, approaching his hideout. The green house door creaks as he steps inside. The plants wave in the quiet night. Settling onto his crate, he inspects the charge indicator on his guitar. It's blinking empty. From his pocket, he pulls out the new Stress Relay from Dr. White.

He inspects it, turns it over in his hands, and clicks it once. A simple melody jingle plays. It stops, unfinished. Missing the last two notes.

Jax tilts his head

Jax

That's our song.

He pushes the button again, the relay plays the melody. It cuts out again, right before the resolution. Jax grabs his guitar, clicks the button. The relay plays the jingle one last time. This time, as it reaches the incomplete section, Jax plays the final two notes with his guitar.

The soundwaves resonate over the relay. It POPS open like a container with a loud mechanical click. Jax jumps back, startled by it. Immediately, an audio track begins to play from the relay.

THE SHADOW

(Static, distorted, bad quality)

THEY NEED TO BE STOPPED. THE MUSICIANS IN THIS DISTRICT. THEY THINK MUSIC IS A GIFT. SOMETHING YOU'RE BORN WITH.

I STUDIED FOR YEARS. I WAS TECHNICALLY BETTER THAN ANYONE IN MY CLASSES. THEY SAID I HAD NO PASSION. NO HEART.

CHEAP TRICKS AND EMOTION. WEAKNESS. MELODIC JUSTICE. WASTED EQUIPMENT ON PEOPLE WHO DON'T UNDERSTAND. MUSIC IS A SCIENCE. NOT A FEELING. I'LL SHOW THEM WHAT HAPPENS WHEN TALENT MEETS REAL POWER.

Dr. White

(over recording)

That should be enough-

The relay goes silent as Jax stares at it, trying to take in all of this information.

Jax

He was a musician?

Jax grabs the opened container, on the inside, the letters are written "ARASHI"

Jax

Arashi. That's the name Dr. White said.

(he pauses for a moment)

Loop, Call Hiro

The Loop bloops and Hiro connects instantly.

Hiro

Hello?

Jax

Hiro, were you awake again?

Hiro

Yes... another late night. What's troubling you?
Concert day nerves?

Jax

Not exactly. I found something. About **THE SHADOW**. Who
he was a long time ago.

Hiro

What did you find?

Jax

He was a musician. Back in the 2030s. He failed. And
now he's... he's targeting us because we're everything
he couldn't be.

Hiro

There were many talented musicians who didn't make it
back then. The industry was brutal. Most of them moved
on.

Jax

But he didn't. He let it define him.

Hiro

How did you learn this?

Jax

This relay Dr. White gave me. He put a message in it.

Hiro

What kind of message

Jax

A recording of THE SHADOW talking about us. Our band.
It sounded like Dr. White's voice at the end too.

Hiro

You should talk to Dr. White. He knows more about
Black Sun than anyone.

Jax

You think I can trust him?

Hiro

He's fought with THE SHADOW longer than any of us.
If he left you the message, there's a reason.

Jax

I will, Hiro. Dr. White built something good out of what happened to him. I need to know how. I'm gonna head over there one more time before the show. You'll be there tonight, right?

Hiro

We'll see. The shop.

Jax

Yeah, yeah. The shop.

Hiro

Good night, Jax. Be careful!

The Loop disconnects. Jax lays his guitar against the wall and sits. Looking out the greenhouse door hole at the city lights.

Jax

(repeating Hiro)

Be careful.

(he breathes deep)

He lifts himself off the ground. As he lifts, his elbow bumps the base of his guitar. A soft DING. Buttons flash. A panel shifts slightly, then snaps back. Jax freezes. Stares.

Jax

You got secrets too?

The guitar lights turn off. Jax picks it up and leaves the greenhouse.

We fade to black.

A slow clicking...

Fade back in

Jax is standing outside the Stress Relay offices again. He looks to his Loop. He hovers his hand over the New Message button to Kiko. He decides to wait.

Jax

I need to talk to Dr. White so he can protect all of us.

INT. STRESS RELAY HEADQUARTERS - ELEVATOR - AFTERNOON

Jax stands alone in the pristine elevator, finger hovering over the top floor button. He takes a breath, pushes it.

INT. DR. WHITE'S OFFICE - CONTINUOUS

The elevator opens up, Jax walks through to the office doors. To his surprise, Dr. White is gone. He approaches the desk, the papers are scattered and rummaged through like someone was looking for something. Jax walks around to the front of the desk cautiously.

*He rifles through more papers, he sees messages from that name again. **Arashi**.*

*As he reaches to grab his Loop from his pocket, he notices something metallic glints beneath the scattered papers. A **Black Sun** necklace, the exact one that attacked Kai. Its compartment lies open, connected to a Stress Relay by a thin cord.*

*On Dr. White's screen, multiple tabs are open. A map with three pulsing dots labeled **JAX, KAI, KIKO, MAXWELL**... Above that, text reads out "**SIGNATURES**" and behind it, a half-closed incident report. Jax leans*

closer. The words "ARASHI INCIDENT" and "DISTRICT MUSIC PROGRAM SHUTDOWN" peek through.

Jax

That zap. It tagged us. He used that necklace and the relays to track us.

The bathroom door CREAKS. A voice echoes from inside:

DR. WHITE

(Off screen)

What? Last quarter's data looked great!

Jax yanks the necklace free, stuffs it in his pocket. The doorknob starts to turn.

He bolts out of the room, throwing his Relay tracker from Dr. White to the side. In the hallway, fumbling with his Loop, he calls Kiko.

Jax

Call Kiko

The Loop bloops. No answer.

Jax

Call Hiro

The Loops Bloops again. No answer.

Jax

What the hell??

(frantically leaving message)

Hiro, it's all a lie. White's working for them. **Black Sun**. The concert. We're out of time. Where are you?

He hangs up the device.

Jax

(cont'd)

Where could he be?

Fade to black... the sound of a relay clicking becomes almost constant. The fastest we've heard yet.

It stops.

Fade in...

INT. CONCERT VENUE - BACKSTAGE - NIGHT

Kiko and Kai are in pre-show mode. Through the curtain, the crowd buzzes.

Kiko

(to Kai)

Packed house.

Kai

(beaming)

One... two... three... twenty-six at least. Wow!

The actual crowd is easily over a hundred. Kiko just stares at him blankly.

Jax bursts in, out of breath.

Kiko

Jax? What's wrong?

Kai

Yeah man chill you still have like...

He checks his wrist for a watch that isn't there.

Jax

I tried calling you guys but you didn't answer.

Kiko

We've been busy getting ready!

Jax

(slowing down)

I know...I know. I need to tell you guys something.
About **Black Sun**.

Kiko

Okay?

Jax

After what they did to my family... I... I tried to stop them myself. I followed a group of them back to a warehouse. I thought I could end it alone. It nearly cost me everything.

FLASH - Umbrals surrounding him, cybernetics sparking and failing

FLASH - Jax collapsing in an alley, vision flickering out

FLASH - Hiro helping Jax stand up. Correcting his cybernetics that fell out.

Jax (V.O)

If Hiro hadn't found me...

Kai

Woah...

Jax

But now we've got bigger problems.

*He pulls out the **Black Sun** necklace. Kai recoils.*

I found this in White's office. Along with proof he's funding the **Black Sun's** operations.

Kiko

What? How?

Jax

Those relays he gave us? They're trackers. You need to destroy yours. Now!

Kai yanks his Relay out, SMASHES it with the back of a drumstick. Red lights begin to flare, an alarm SHRIEKS. He stomps it out.

Kiko

(reaching for her bag)

Mine's in my-

Her bag starts WAILING, pulsing red. She rips out the Relay, tosses it to Jax who SMASHES it with a final slam.

Kiko

We have to find White. Stop him before someone gets hurt.

Jax

(studying the necklace)

Look. There's a switch...

Jax clicks open the necklace's compartment, flips the switch. Kai flinches. The necklace rises slowly, dark energy crackling.

They freeze. The necklace hovers, then drifts away.

Jax

It might go back to him

Kiko

Okay, we go on soon, so let's make this quick.

Kai

Alright ladies first!

INT. CONCERT VENUE - BACKSTAGE HALLWAY - NIGHT

The band rushes down the hallway, it gets darker and darker.

Kai

I can't believe we're following this thing.

They creep after it. Voices echo ahead. Rounding the corner, they find Hiro standing over Dr. White, who's bound up on the floor. The necklace shoots to White's outstretched hand and powers down.

Dr. White

Hiro, I assure you. You don't understand.

Hiro

(pressing staff against White's chest)

I think I understand perfectly.

Dr White

WAIT!

Hiro strikes him. White collapses.

Hiro

(to Jax)

I got your message and came straight to the venue.
Found Dr. White backstage, he was on a Loop call with
THE SHADOW. Said he put trackers on you.

Jax

It's okay, we destroyed them.

Hiro

Good. He was on the loop with **THE SHADOW**. He was about
to send your locations.

(nudges White)

Not today.

Kiko

Hiro, we can't thank you enough.

Hiro

Thank me by giving these people a show they won't
forget. Now go on!

*The band exchanges looks, nods. As they hurry back,
Jax glances over his shoulder at Hiro standing guard.
In closeup, Dr. White's robotic eye looks side to
side.*

Kai

Wow. I can't believe Dr. White was really trying to
off us this whole time.

Jax

The Black Sun must be bigger than we thought. But with him stopped, we can make real changes. For now, we gotta put on this concert.

The band members head into the backstage room to prepare for their show. Jax sits down and grabs his instrument.

Jax pulls out the Stress Relay he got from Hiro. He takes the cord, and takes a deeper look at the guitar port. He connects the Stress Relay and his guitar together. As they connect, the guitar dings and a mechanical whirring begins inside. A new charge indicator light comes on around the back side of the guitar. It fills to the half-way mark. As Jax begins to investigate closer, a venue worker comes in.

Venue Worker

Oh thank goodness, you're back. You guys are on in just a few seconds!

5-4-3-2

She pushes them out onto the stage.

INT. CONCERT VENUE — STAGE - NIGHT

The band members rush on to the stage and the crowd gets worked up. We see the colors through Kiko's goggles again. They set up their equipment and quickly get in position to perform. Kiko takes a deep breath. The other band members follow. People start to quiet down.

Kiko

Hey everyone! We are Melodic Justice!

The crowd cheers again with support.

Kiko

(louder)

Let's get into it! Thank you for coming out! Toss your Stress Relays out the window, good vibes only tonight!

The band mates look at each other and nod. The first song begins and the crowd is ecstatic.

Through Kiko's goggles, waves of color wash over the crowd. The song continues and the band mates soak in their moment. We see close ups of each of the band mates in a mini montage. The song comes to an end.

The band members look at each other and smile. Kiko signals. Kai gives a beat and they launch into their second song.

In the middle of the song, the band members start to notice some disturbance at the entrance. Security starts to head to the door.

Jax keeps playing, eyes darting between the door and his bandmates. Kiko looks concerned but keeps playing.

Dark figures start to push through security. One guard goes down. Then another. The crowd starts to turn their focus.

The music dies out. The band mates drop their instruments. Kai stands up from his stool.

The Black Sun has arrived.

Chaos erupts. The crowds group together towards the back exits as Umbrals surge inside, their dark energy

slowly growing throughout the room. Some fans scramble for exits, some try to fight back but ultimately fail.

Jax snaps-to as the chaos unfolds. Beside him, Kiko and Kai stand frozen, their instruments forgotten.

Jax

We have to do something!

Kiko

The crowd, we need to get people out!

The band sprints to the side of the stage. An Umbral charges up the steps. Kai's drumstick WHISTLES through the air, striking its head. Kiko swings her keytar like a bat, taking it down.

Jax scans for something to use as a weapon, guitar sitting heavy on his back. He slides it off, pushing it away safely. He grabs a steel pole, SWEEPS the legs of two more Umbrals blocking the stage stairs.

Kai

Now that's what I'm talkin' -

Kai is tackled by an Umbral Mid-Sentence. They land hard across the stage. Jax rushes over with his steel pole. He WHACKS the Umbral as hard as he can and it falls to the side. He helps Kai back up and the band runs together. Kai spots a specific umbral in the crowd. Through the dark energy he sees a recognizable face. The umbral turns and Kai sees his hollow white eyes. He's barely in there.

Kai

Alex?...

Kiko

(pulling Kai)

Kai, we have to go! We can't help him!

Kai is torn, but he knows she's right. The band mates help scattered fans as they reach the exit.

Kiko

NOW!!

She pulls Kai's arm and they exit with the civilians, but Jax stops.

Jax

(to Kai and Kiko)

Go! Get people to safety. I need to get my guitar.

Kiko

Jax, you're bleeding!

Kiko screams out, but he's already limping back inside. An Umbral lunges at Jax, but he slides past it. It impales itself on a broken pole. The other Umbrals are busy feasting. Jax helps pull a trapped fan out of the rubble, and he guides them to Kiko at the door. He runs up to the stage.

Jax reaches his guitar and picks it up. He stands at the front of the venue, scanning the Umbral-infested room. He has no choice but to fight back.

He searches desperately for a good weapon as three more Umbrals close in on him...

Jax's hand trembles on his Stress Relay. Click. Click. Click-click-click... They creep in... We see the charge indicator light fill up slowly on the guitar with each few clicks. He's surrounded.

When the bar is full, his guitar lets out a DING and then hums. A pulse of energy ripples through it, building to a high-pitched whine. Green light blazes from its seams.

*The camera circles Jax as the guitar **TRANSFORMS!** Panels slide, the mechanisms whir. As the panels shift out with mechanical arms, lights blare out from every seam. The neck extends out and splits. The ends ignite to create a laser-tipped barrel. The instrument unfolds masterfully into a massive laser-machine-gun-relay guitar.*

The gun-tar finishes building itself in his hands.

Jax stares in disbelief at the weapon in his hands as he pulses with power.

It DINGS again. Ready to go.

His finger finds the trigger.

TIME SLOWS

Red laser bolts tear through the air, cutting down Umbrals with beams of light. Each shot leaves trails of energy hanging in the air for a moment.

Jax spins, weapon blazing, each burst tearing through enemies. Umbrals fall in slow motion, dissolving into shadow as their tendrils retract.

REAL TIME

More umbrals spill into the venue. He dives behind cover like a video game scene, heart pounding. He takes a moment to breathe. He looks down at the instrument in first person when-

The wall besides him EXPLODES inward, showering him with debris. The force throws him to the side. Equipment crashes from the stage. Amps, stands, and Kai's drum pad falls and tangles in cables.

THE SHADOW enters the room.

His imposing dark figure emerges through the dust and debris. His presence seems to drain light from the room. We see a massive power bank of corrupted relays attached to his back, providing a complete, charged, dark mask around his body. The wires connect into the back of his head.

Jax

(struggling to stand up)

Oh shit...

THE SHADOW stalks forward, each step deliberate. His distorted laugh reverbs unnaturally through the venue.

Jax's guitar starts to tremble, transforming back into its normal form. Almost like it was cowering, but it's just the battery already out.

*Jax stands still, looking at his weapon-turned-instrument in fear. His fingers find the Relay button. Click. Click. **CLICK-CLICK-CLICK.***

Jax

(tapping button violently)

Come on come ON COME ON **COME ON!!!!**

THE SHADOW

(voice distorting reality)

I'VE BEEN WAITING FOR THIS ONE...

*Jax aims the guitar at him, hammering the Relay as **THE SHADOW** looms over him. He lifts his arms up to smash down on Jax. He holds his arms up for what feels like forever, then SLAMS them down. BUT-*

- CRACK! A burst of red electricity spits through the air.

*DR. WHITE stands between them! The air stands still. Everything around them pauses. The energy around the cane crackles with power. Jax notices the **Black Sun** necklace is connected to the cane, feeding into its energy. A cage of electricity creeps from the cane around **THE SHADOW'S** body, attaching to his network of relays. Everything pauses.*

Dr. White

*I've let you control me for far too long, Arashi!
Threatening my work, my legacy, everyone I try to
help...*

(grips cane)

Today? It stops.

*Dr. White raises his cane. **THE SHADOW** rises with it in his electric cage, suspended in the air with energy. With a massive motion, Dr. White SLAMS him down, along with a massive energy beam that sends **THE SHADOW** flying away through debris.*

Jax looks closer to see that Dr. White's cybernetic eye is missing. Just an empty socket.

Jax

Hiro... he had you tied up. Your eye!

Dr. White

I explained everything. I had to destroy the eye. It's how he watches me. I know what it's like... being in this guy's way.

(the camera swings over, the rubble shift)

Trust me. He's getting up!

*They look back over and **THE SHADOW** is removing rubble off of himself.*

Jax

Well let's make him pay.

Jax's relay WHINES. The guitar pulses back to life, charged back up again.

THE SHADOW

JETT'S BROTHER. I SHOULD HAVE FINISHED YOU TWELVE YEARS AGO.

*Jax's face displays his anger. **THE SHADOW** charges right for them. Jax's weapon transforms in a flash of light, unleashing a barrage of laser fire.*

Jax

AHHHHH!

*Dr. White's cane sends massive energy beams arcing through the air, but **THE SHADOW** is too quick, ripping up a section of wall to use as cover.*

***THE SHADOW** hurls a metal divider. Jax's laser fire tears through it mid-flight, slicing it in half.*

*Dark energy swirls between **THE SHADOW's** raised hands, forming a pulsing sphere of darkness powered by his*

corrupted power bank. Jax and Dr. White look at each other shocked at the technology. **THE SHADOW** throws the energy ball. They dive for cover in opposite directions as the sphere flies toward them and detonates, filling the venue with smoke and debris.

Through the chaos, Jax flanks around, catching **THE SHADOW** with a burst of precision fire. He staggers, disoriented. Across the room, Dr. White pulls himself up.

Jax shoots a perfect laser circle in the ceiling above **THE SHADOW**. The roof crashes down, burying him in rubble. He runs to the doctor's side.

Jax

Dr. White! Stay with me, he's gonna get us!

Dr. White

(with determination)

Jax... he's not here for us. He's here for you. He's been forcing me to help him. The relays, the sponsorship... I led him right to you.

Jax

What? I'm not sure this is the time, Doc.

THE SHADOW emerges from the rubble, roaring.

Dr. White

He knows you're Jett's brother. He's been hunting you since the moment he realized you're still out there. The crowd, the venue. It's all bait.

(hands Jax the necklace)

This will counteract the dark energy. I modified this one.

Jax

You sure that will work?

Dr. White

It's all we got. If we hit him at the same time we could break his protective layer.

THE SHADOW is ready to charge again.

Jax

Let's finish what Jett started.

Jax looks at Dr. White, emotion and determination mixing on his face. He grabs the necklace and moves into position. **THE SHADOW** creates an array of small energy beams. Jax dives to cover as Dr. White provides covering fire. Finally reaching position, Jax and Dr. White exchange nods.

THE SHADOW begins gathering power, a larger sphere of darkness growing between his hands again. He aims at Dr. White and fires.

Jax connects all the devices, but behind him we see movement. An Umbral getting up. Alex, or what's left of him. Through hollow white eyes, he spots Jax.

Jax

Three...Two...

Alex lunges forward, debris in hand and CRACK, it connects with Jax's neck.

The world tilts in first-person. Colors blur. Sound fades to nothing as Jax crumples to the floor.

Dr. White

(distant, echoing)

NOOO!!

*Dr. White's red energy beams SPLASH against **THE SHADOW's** makeshift shield.*

We see Kai and Kiko coming in through the doorway at just that moment, screaming out.

The camera SINKS lower, Jax's unconscious body filling the frame as the combat blurs out of focus.

FADE TO BLACK

Silence.

Then...

Click.

Click-click.

Click-click-click.

The Relay's clicking builds to a fever pitch before suddenly stopping.

The darkness splits open in a flashback.

INT. JAX CHILDHOOD HOME - NIGHT

A memory surfaces, the night of Jett's death. Earlier that day.

Young Jax creeps down the hallway, following a strange mechanical hum. He finds Jett hunched over their father's desk, connecting wires to a jerry-rigged Stress Relay device. Sparks fly.

Young Jax

(whispering)

Jett?

Jett spins, hiding the device behind him. He relaxes when he realizes it's not mom or dad, just his brother.

Jett

I thought they put you to bed.

Young Jax

What is that?

Jett

Concrete proof of what they're doing. What they're planning.

The device sparks again, data streaming across a small display. Coordinates, names, attack plans.

Jett

I have to get this out. To warn them.

Jax isn't bothered by it. He looks at the piano in the room.

Young Jax

Can't you just play a couple of songs with me?

Jett

(reluctantly pausing)

Ugh, alright. Only a couple.

Young Jax hops up on the piano stool. His brother plays a background record on a record player. Jett

lifts his finger up and sets it down to play one note. With the sound of the note, we cut instantly -

- CRASH! The door splinters. The memory fractures, jumping forward.

Young Jax is pinned to the floor. Through tears, he sees Jett still clutching the modified relay, trying to destroy it as dark tendrils wrap around him.

Jett

(yelling out to the darkness)

The data's already gone! You're too late!

*A massive shadow fills the doorway. **THE SHADOW** himself, though Young Jax doesn't see his face, only the overwhelming darkness. He cackles deeply. Jett locks eyes with Young Jax one last time.*

Jett

Listen to the music, Jax. Just listen to the music.

The darkness consumes the screen as Jett's voice drowns out. We see rapid flashes of the band mates, their smiles, their reactions. We hear small glimpses of Hiro's wisdom. Scenes of the band playing together fly by. Jett's words echo. "Listen to the music..."

DARKNESS

Quick Fade in.

INT. CONCERT VENUE - NIGHT

*Jax's eyes snap open. Through blurred vision, he sees the blackmatter dust of Alex's crushed body beneath **THE SHADOW'S** feet. Kai screams out to him from the entrance. Kiko is trying to hold him back. The sound starts to sync back up around Jax. Back to reality. Jax sees Dr. White falling, and his band members entering the danger zone. **THE SHADOW** delivers a devastating blow to the doctor. He goes crashing down, the cane skips across the debris. **THE SHADOW** kneels back, spent. Jax forces himself up, his body fights against it, but he pushes through... His guitar weighs heavy on his back as he scans the battlefield. Half-dazed.*

He has to think fast. There. Above the stage, a lighting rig dangles by sparking wires, ready to fall.

*He starts moving. **THE SHADOW** turns, raising his arms. Dark energy bolts force Jax to dive between chunks of debris as he scrambles toward the stage.*

*Two shots barely miss him. Then, click. **THE SHADOW** needs recharging.*

***THE SHADOW** laughs, that distorted sound filling the venue. He knows he's still got the upper hand.*

Jax sees the exposed wiring. No time to think. He rips down hard.

The massive rig swings free, electricity arcing.

*CRASH! It slams into **THE SHADOW**, voltage coursing through his relay network. He lands in some debris.*

We quickly cut to Kai and Kiko, trying to figure out how to help.

Kiko

We can't fight him.

Kai

(looking around)

The music. If we can connect it.

*Across the venue, Dr. White is recovering, still weak. **THE SHADOW** is getting back to his feet, smoke rising from his damaged relays.*

Kai

Follow me!

Kai leads Kiko to his drum machine that they left on the stage. He reconnects it to the stage speakers.

Kai

Please work pleaseworkpleasework.

He snaps the cords together, but hovers his finger over the on switch.

Kiko

Nice work!

*The power from the connection causes a slight surge throughout the room. **THE SHADOW** is focused on Jax. He creates small dark energy bursts and sends them his direction. Jax dodges behind cover. Dr White is finally back on his feet, he disconnects the necklace from his cane and powers all of his energy into the device.*

THE SHADOW

ALL OF YOU. THINKING YOUR MUSIC MATTERS. YOU REALLY
THINK YOU'LL MAKE A DIFFERENCE?

Jax

Uhh, Doc? Any ideas?!

*The doctor finishes powering up the necklace. He disconnects it and turns it on. He gives it a hard toss, and the necklace rockets toward **THE SHADOW**, wrapping around his throat, yanking his head back.*

THE SHADOW

AGHGHHGH!!

***THE SHADOW** falls back, howling. Dr White exhausts his cane holding him against the wall. Jax makes it to the doctor with his guitar on his back.*

Jax

(to Dr. White, desperate)

Sir! Sir, are you with me?

Shit.

But White's knocked out cold, spent from all the energy. Jax grabs the cane, his guitar still smoking in his other hand. He stands, unsteady. No words, determined.

***THE SHADOW** starts beating at the necklace that's dragging him with his fists. Jax notices Kai and Kiko on the stage.*

Jax

What are you doing here?? He could kill you?

Kai

He'll have to kill me first!

*Kai flicks the switch on the drum pad. Jax watches as the reverberation sends a distortion through **THE SHADOW's** energy shield. It hurts, but it allows him to break free, and he steadies himself with his remaining arm. The dark energy swims between his fingers. When suddenly.*

BOOM-CLAP. BOOM-BOOM-CLAP.

Jax looks back over to his friends, and grins.

Kiko

Now kick his ass!

*Jax looks back to **THE SHADOW**.*

*Jax quickly runs through the room, almost dancing. He dodges a blast from **THE SHADOW**, sliding across the floor with the beat.*

Jax

Your rhythm always sucked...

*We watch from **THE SHADOW's** point of view as Jax slips in between debris and rubble, firing back with the beat.*

***THE SHADOW** fails to ever hit Jax, firing off-beat every time.*

THE SHADOW

STOP MOVING! ACCEPT THIS IS THE END!

*We switch back to Jax's perspective. He's sitting behind rubble breathing hard. He takes a look over and gets a peak at **THE SHADOW'S** power bank. Some relays are more exposed than ever. He jumps out and rips some energy shots at it. Sparks fly. He fires again, another burst of light cracks the casing. He moves to another position.*

Jax

There it is.

Jax starts charging up the relay. Clicking it non-stop. The beat continues, the background music swells up. He plans out his path.

Jax

(to himself)

For my family...

Jax

For my friends...

*The relays on **THE SHADOW'S** back spark violently. He's lost Jax completely in the mess. Jax plants his feet, strapping the corrupted necklace to the cane. The artifacts pulse together.*

Jax

For everyone you've tried to hurt.

*He gets up, starts running to the stage. **THE SHADOW** starts charging up another large energy ball.*

Jax

It's over.

He sprints up the collapsed lighting rig, climbing to the beat. Each step matches the pounding drum loop as it builds louder.

***THE SHADOW** is growing his sphere of dark energy. He screeches as his dark tentacles whip around his body.*

Jax LEAPS. The Guntar swings from its strap as he grips the cane and necklace. They blaze bright in his hands.

Jax

AHHHHHH!!!

*He slams them down with the drop of the beat. A large multi-colored beam flies toward **THE SHADOW** as their powers collide.*

-BOOOOOOOOOOOM-

*The shockwave throws Jax backwards as smoke engulfs the venue. Through the clearing haze, **THE SHADOW** crawls toward the exit. His shield and mask are cracked, and his real face peeks through the darkness. He makes a run for it.*

Jax lies there, spent. Victory and exhaustion wash over him. After a long moment, he forces himself up, stumbling to Dr. White.

Jax

(roughly)

You going to make it?

Dr. White

I think I'll be okay. But I'm not that kind of doctor.

We pan to the exit door nearby and see Kiko and Kai peek in. They come running inside to Jax's aid.

Kiko

My goodness, Jax, are you okay?

Kai

I've never seen anything like that in my life yo!!

Jax

I think I'm okay, thank you guys.

Kai

(pointing to Jax's guitar)

What is that thing? That was insane!

Jax

I don't know... I had no idea it could do that. It really helped me out though.

Kiko

So that's him ...**THE SHADOW**..?

Dr. White

(patting off dust from jacket)

That's him. Their leader. I'm surprised you even got to see him. He doesn't normally come out, or cause a big scene like this. I take full responsibility for all of this

Jax

So what's the deal? Who are you working for, really?

Dr. White

I never worked for them willingly. **THE SHADOW** has been trying to pull my strings for years... He threatens my legacy, my work. I did everything I could to prevent him from arriving, but it wasn't enough. I've had enough of him controlling me... threatening my life. I think with all of us together, we'll be strong enough to stop him. For good.

Kai

I mean come on, Jax. You totally busted out the mega lasers on him. Maybe he's finally feeling the heat. Like, maybe he's been dodging his karma for way too long. And now it's caught up.

Jax

I'm sorry about your friend Alex.

Kai

This isn't over yet. We can't stand down now...

Kiko

We still need to bring **THE SHADOW** into the light.

Jax helps Dr. White up, the four of them stand in the middle of the rubble-strewn room.

Fade to black.

EPILOGUE

- THE NEXT DAY -

EXT. HIRO'S MUSIC SHOP - MORNING

We fade to the next day. Jax is walking up to Hiro's Shop entrance one last time.

INT. HIRO'S MUSIC SHOP - MORNING

Jax walks up to Hiro to talk more about what happened to him last night. He sees Hiro is now wearing a sling.

Jax

I guess I'm not the only one getting into trouble, you didn't mention that over the loop.

Hiro

It turns out the doctor is only generous... in handing out ass whoopings. Though I did deserve it.

Jax

We were both wrong about Dr. White. **Black Sun** did come for us. But luckily, he actually helped us... and well...

(he looks to guitar)

This came in handy. I did not know it could do that.

Hiro

There are many things in life that you do not know yet, my boy. But time will tell. I am glad you found it useful. I had to leave to patch myself up, but I knew I had nothing to worry about. There has been talk all over the district about the man who defeated **THE SHADOW**.

Jax

Haha, well thanks Hiro, I couldn't have done it without you. My bandmates should be stopping by soon, Kai wanted to see your shop and meet you officially. You know, without someone tied up below you.

Hiro

(excitedly)

Oh good! I have something I want to give them.

Jax

Really? Like what?

Hiro

You will see. Meanwhile though...I have one more thing
I want to tell you.

Jax

What could it possibly be now? You've set the bar
pretty high.

Hiro

I assume you recall the story I told you of the young
musician. Who fell ill? Do you know who that musician
was?

Jax

No, you never told me their name.

Hiro

(laying his hands on Jax's guitar)

This instrument was once the personal guitar of the
one and only legend, Yori Takahashi .

(Hiro points to poster of Yori on the shop wall)

*A musical bell jingle begins as Kai and Kiko enter the
store. Jax stares in awe at his instrument.*

Kiko

Hello again Mr. Tanaka

Kai

(looking around confused)

Wait... I HAVE been here before!

Hiro

Good morning to you all, you must follow me. I have something special to show you.

The TV in the shop shows a broadcast.

News Reporter

(on t.v.)

...chaos at the Midnight District Concert Hall last night, as an organized attack was stopped by local band Melodic Justice and Stress Relay CEO Maxwell White. Authorities are investigating **Black Sun's** involvement. This marks the first major victory against the criminal group that has continuously targeted our local community...

Hiro gestures over and leads them to the record shelf behind the register. Hiro jokingly pulls a book back like most secret doors would open... However, nothing happens. He smiles, and laughs.

Hiro

Just kidding.

He looks at the band mates. He then pushes the real button that is under the register. After he pushes it, the whole case lowers down into the floor. We sink down to reveal a whole room of weapons and ammunition below. Hiro gives them instrument weapons that fit

them. For Kiko, a portable keyboard that can send sonic blasts. Kai receives a pair of drum sticks that connect into extendable Nun-Chucks (Drum-Chucks).

Hiro stands in front of Jax. He takes a small mechanical box and attaches it to Jax's guitar. It unfolds around the guitar and creates a design that matches Yori Takashi's famous guitar..

All of the band members get together in action poses. We spin around them to see their backs and as the camera rotates, the background transitions from the weapons room to the top of the roof. We see the band members facing the rest of the district they have chosen to protect.. We fade to white when..

***THE SHADOW** appears through the screen with an evil laugh. He pulls out his dark gun and shoots the white screen with dark energy shots, turning the screen black. The shots fill in the screen to reveal the title.*

MELODIC JUSTICE TITLE SCREEN

CREDITS

DIRECTED BY

KARSTEN ALLEN

WRITTEN BY

KARSTEN ALLEN

EDITED BY

KARSTEN ALLEN

VFX/CGI SUPERVISOR

KARSTEN ALLEN

CONCEPT ART

KARSTEN ALLEN

CHARACTER DESIGN

KARSTEN ALLEN

MUSIC SUPERVISOR

KARSTEN ALLEN

AFTER CREDITS TEASER SCENE

Jax is standing in front of a grey door alone, checking the time and tapping his foot. The door slides up, fog rolls out, and a silhouette stands in the way. It walks forward. It's revealed to be the famous Yori Takahashi. Jax's jaw drops. It goes black,

Jax

(over black screen)

Yori?

a Melodic Justice Tour poster is posted on the screen. A "2" is stamped over the "Tour"